



JavaScript Console Essentials

Brief Overview

This note covering **JavaScript Basics** was created from an [uploaded document](#). It covers console basics, snippet workflows, alert usage, syntax conventions, and error handling.

Key Points

- Quick access to Chrome DevTools console and snippet editor.
- How alert works and its syntax.
- Core syntax elements and style guidelines.
- Identifying and fixing common ReferenceErrors.



Accessing the JavaScript Console

- Open a new tab in **Chrome**.
- Menu → **View** → **Developer** → **JavaScript Console**.
- The console executes each line as soon as **Enter** is pressed.

Definition: The **JavaScript Console** is an interactive environment where you can type JavaScript expressions and see the results immediately.

- **Multi-line input:** press **Shift + Enter** to stay on the same statement and continue writing on the next line.



Using Snippets in Chrome DevTools

- Navigate to **Sources** → click the left-corner arrow → **Snippets**.
- Click **+ New snippet**, name the file (e.g., index.js).
- Write your JavaScript code, then press the **Run** button (bottom-right).

Feature	JavaScript Console	Snippets Editor
Execution timing	Runs each line immediately (Enter)	Runs the whole script when Run is clicked
Multi-line coding	Needs Shift + Enter to avoid early execution	No special key needed; write the entire script first

Typical use case	Quick tests and one-off statements	Developing and testing small scripts
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The alert Function

Definition: `alert(message)` is a built-in **function** that displays a modal pop-up containing the supplied *message* and an **OK** button.

```
alert("Hello!");
alert("World");
```

- **Full form:** `window.alert(message)`.
- **Short form:** `alert(message)` (most common).

Components of an alert statement

Part	Example	Purpose
Keyword	<code>alert</code>	Informs the browser to display a pop-up.
Parentheses	<code>(...)</code>	Encloses the argument(s) for the function.
String (quotes)	<code>"Hello!"</code>	Text to be shown; quotes indicate a <i>string</i> literal.
Semicolon	<code>;</code>	Marks the end of the statement (like a period in English).

Syntax Elements in JavaScript

Symbol	English Analogy	Role in Code
<code>;</code>	Full stop (.)	Terminates a statement.
<code>"</code> or <code>'</code>	Quotation marks	Delimits a <i>string</i> ; both are equivalent for JavaScript.

()	Parentheses	Group function arguments.
//	Comment marker	(Not shown in lecture, but part of grammar.)

Note: In word processors, opening and closing quotation marks look different; programming requires the same straight quote (" or ') for both ends.

Finding Documentation

- Visit [MDN Web Docs](#) → select [JavaScript](#).
- Search for [alert](#) → first result is [Window.alert\(\)](#).
- MDN provides:
 - Description of the method.
 - Syntax and optional parameters.
 - Example usage and expected output.

Style Guidelines

- **No spaces** between the keyword, parentheses, quotes, and semicolon:
`alert("Hello!");`
- **Double quotes** are the preferred style for strings in most JavaScript codebases (e.g., `"Hello!"`).
- Consistency is emphasized: code should appear as if a single author wrote it, regardless of how many contributors are involved.

Definition: A **style guide** is a documented set of conventions that ensures code looks uniform and remains readable across a project.

- Reference for JavaScript style: the community-maintained guide on MDN (often called the *JavaScript style guide*).

! Common Errors

- Using an undefined identifier results in a [ReferenceError](#).

```
say("Hello"); // ❌ Uncaught ReferenceError: say is not defined
```

Definition: ReferenceError is thrown when JavaScript encounters a variable or function name that hasn't been declared in the current scope.

- The browser's error message points out the unknown keyword, prompting you to check proper documentation for valid commands.